> threat, then explained by the record we had more reason to feel that way than they did. His opener was about 30 minutes, then we went into dialogue. I had taken notes on his pitch and rebutted with fact and figure a number of his points. I kept emphasizing that we were the two nations that could destroy or save the world. I figured they nurse a grudge that we don't respect them as a super power. All in all, three hours including lunch were I believe well spent. Everyone at our end think he's going home with a pretty clear view of where we stand.

We agreed to the customary step of inviting the foreign minister to a small luncheon in the White House, which was also the practice when a head of state visited. As hostess of the White House, Nancy came to the reception. Before lunch, Gromyko came over to her, took her to the side, and whispered in her ear: "Does your husband believe in peace?" Nancy said, "Yes, of course." And he said, "Then whisper the word *peace* in his ear every night." And she said, "I will, and I'll also whisper it in your ear," and she leaned over and did it. For the first time that day, "Grim Grom," as he had been nicknamed by some, cracked a smile.

Gromyko was convinced of the rightness of the Soviet position, and it was impossible for me not to sense in this frosty old Stalinist the confidence that, despite all its problems, Communism was going to prevail over capitalism and eventually there would be a one-world Communist state. We had three hours of give-and-take. I told him we were willing to go back to the negotiating table, but only if the Soviets indicated a genuine interest in negotiating an equitable and mutually satisfactory agreement. As I'd planned, I also tried to let him know the Soviet Union had nothing to fear from us. But if I scored any points, Gromyko didn't admit it to me. He was as hard as granite. He said